MODULE 10 · DOMAIN 2 - OUTPUT EVALUATION AND VALIDATION

Refining for the Audience, and Choosing the Format

Editing an output for the person who will read it, and choosing between inline text, an artifact and structured data.

DOMAIN 2 of 7 EXAM WEIGHT 21% MODULE 10 of 33

admin@sthithapragna.com

The same facts, written for a different reader, are **a different document**.

admin@sthithapragna.com

Who is reading, and what they need

READER	WHAT THEY NEED FIRST
The board	The decision asked of them; scannable, verified, house terms
Investors	The headline result early, the main drivers, then the outlook
Site supervisors	What changes for them and what to do, in plain words
A client's procurement panel	Every requirement answered, in their order and their words
A specialist team	Detail, method and assumptions they can check

ON THE EXAM

Name the reader, then ask: what do they need first, and what can they do without?

Story order, or bottom line up front?

STORY ORDER

Background first

- Context and history
- Method
- Findings
- The answer, at the end

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

Answer first

- The answer or decision
- Why, in brief
- What happens next
- Detail for those who want it

THE TIEBREAKER

Busy readers with fixed time get the headline first.

What refining actually involves

- **Reorder for the reader:** their most important point first.
- **Make it scannable:** clear headings, short paragraphs, one idea each.
- **Align the words:** the organisation's terminology and the reader's vocabulary.
- **Cut and add:** remove what this reader does not need; add the decision, deadline or action they do.
- **Verify while you edit:** refined text is still checked against its sources.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Refining is editing for a reader. It is never a substitute for checking the facts.

Structural defects, worst first

DEFECT	WHY IT HURTS
The conclusion contradicts the evidence	Nobody can tell which part to trust
The main point is buried or missing	The reader acts on the wrong thing, or nothing
Sections in an illogical order	The argument is hard to follow
Repetition	Wastes attention and blurs the point
Inconsistent formatting	Looks careless, but meaning survives

ON THE EXAM

Defects that change what a reader understands outrank defects that change how it looks.

Three formats, three jobs

FORMAT	CHOOSE IT WHEN	EXAMPLE
Inline text	Read once, in the chat	A quick answer
Artifact	Kept, shared, edited or shown	Proposal, deck, dashboard
Structured data	Many records, or for a system	Table, CSV, JSON

THE TIEBREAKER

Ask what will happen to the output next. That decides its format.

Artifacts in 2026

- **Artifacts open beside the chat** and live in an Artifacts tab. They start private to you.
- **Templates since September 2026:** Docs, Slides and Design, plus Dashboards in beta.
- **Export to familiar formats:** Docs to Word, PDF or Google Docs; Slides to PowerPoint, PDF or Google Slides.
- **Interactive charts and diagrams** can also appear inline in chat, since March 2026.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The guide's rule still holds: something to keep, share or present belongs in an artifact. Check your plan for which templates you have.

Table, or prose?

USE A TABLE

Many records, same fields

- One row per record
- One column per measure
- Sorted by what matters
- Easy to scan and compare

USE PROSE

A line of reasoning

- An argument or explanation
- Cause and effect
- A recommendation and why
- A narrative for a person

THE TIEBREAKER

A train timetable is a table for a reason. An argument is prose for a reason.

Structured data for another system

- **Match the target exactly:** the column headings, order and formats the system expects.
- **Keep it consistent:** one date format, one unit, one row per record.
- **Let code execution build the file**: a real CSV or spreadsheet, not text that looks like one.
- **Check a sample before importing.** One wrong column shifts every row.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> When a system will read the output, the system's format is the specification.

Comparing drafts, and curating information

- **Compare drafts against the same criteria**, side by side, not by preference.
- **Ask Claude for a structured comparison:** how each draft meets each criterion, with examples.
- **Choose, or merge the best of both**, and say why.
- **Curate:** group related points, order by importance to the reader, remove duplicates, label sources.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> "I prefer this one" is not a comparison. "This one meets four criteria out of five" is.

> Claude produced a careful four-page explanation of Halden's new lone-working rules. It is accurate and complete.
>
> Site supervisors read updates on their phones, between jobs, and must brief their teams by Friday.

Which adaptation is most appropriate for this audience?

A Keep all four pages, because completeness matters most for safety

B Lead with what changes for them and the actions to take, in short plain sentences, linking the full policy

C Add more background on the law behind the rules

D Reformat it as a formal letter from the operations director

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which adaptation is most appropriate for this audience?

A Keep all four pages, because completeness matters most for safety

Complete but unread on a phone helps nobody.

B Lead with what changes for them and the actions to take, in short plain sentences, linking the full policy

Fits the reader, the device and the deadline, and keeps the detail available.

C Add more background on the law behind the rules

Makes it longer for readers who need it shorter.

D Reformat it as a formal letter from the operations director

Changes the tone, not the length or the order.

THE SIGNAL

Phones, between jobs, a Friday deadline: what changes, what to do, in plain words.

> Halden's operations director wants Claude to summarise last week across all 260 sites: visits completed, visits missed and complaints, by region.
>
> The summary is for the Monday operations meeting, where managers look for problem sites.

Which output format communicates this most clearly?

A. A short narrative paragraph for each site

B. One paragraph summarising the whole week

C. A table with one row per site and a column per measure, sortable by region, plus a short list of exceptions

D. A slide deck with one slide for each site

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which output format communicates this most clearly?

A. A short narrative paragraph for each site
Hundreds of paragraphs cannot be scanned or compared.

B. One paragraph summarising the whole week
Hides the problem sites managers are looking for.

C. A table with one row per site and a column per measure, sortable by region, plus a short list of exceptions
Many records, same fields: a table, with exceptions surfaced.

D. A slide deck with one slide for each site
Hundreds of slides. Nobody can compare across them.

THE SIGNAL

Many records with the same fields, read to find exceptions: a table.

> Halden staff are asking Claude for five different things this morning.
>
> Some will be kept, edited or presented. Others will be read once and forgotten.

Which two are best produced as artifacts rather than inline text? Choose two.

A. A client proposal the bid team will edit together and export to Word

B. A one-line answer to which room the meeting is in

C. A slide deck for Friday's board presentation

D. A quick explanation of what a term in a contract means

E. A two-sentence reply to a colleague's question

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two are best produced as artifacts rather than inline text? Choose two.

A A client proposal the bid team will edit together and export to Word

Kept, edited by several people, exported: an artifact.

B A one-line answer to which room the meeting is in

Read once. Inline text.

C A slide deck for Friday's board presentation

Presented and kept: an artifact.

D A quick explanation of what a term in a contract means

Read once in the chat. Inline text.

E A two-sentence reply to a colleague's question

Short and disposable. Inline text.

THE SIGNAL

Kept, shared, edited or presented: artifact. Read once: inline.

> Halden's finance team asks Claude to extract the supplier name, invoice number, date and amount from fifty supplier invoices.
>
> The results will be imported into the purchase ledger, which accepts a CSV file with fixed column headings.

Which output approach fits best?

A. A bullet list of details for each invoice

B. A CSV file with exactly the ledger's headings and one row per invoice, checked on a sample before import

C. A narrative summary of the month's invoices

D. A slide for each supplier showing its invoices

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which output approach fits best?

A — A bullet list of details for each invoice

Readable by people, not importable by the ledger.

B — A CSV file with exactly the ledger's headings and one row per invoice, checked on a sample before import

Matches the system's format, and checks before it goes in.

C — A narrative summary of the month's invoices

Loses the record-level data the ledger needs.

D — A slide for each supplier showing its invoices

A presentation format for a data import.

THE SIGNAL

A system will read it: the system's format is the specification.

> Claude produced two drafts of Halden's spring newsletter for clients. The marketing team is split over which to use.
>
> The team agreed criteria in advance: accuracy, the three required announcements, the client audience, and a length limit.

What is the best way to choose between the drafts?

A Use the longer draft, because it covers more

B Take a quick vote among the team

C Score both against the agreed criteria, then choose or merge on that basis

D Ask Claude which draft it prefers

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best way to choose between the drafts?

A Use the longer draft, because it covers more
Length is not a criterion, and may break the limit.

B Take a quick vote among the team
Preference, not the agreed standard.

C Score both against the agreed criteria, then choose or merge on that basis
Uses the criteria the team already agreed.

D Ask Claude which draft it prefers
A preference without the team's criteria.

THE SIGNAL

Criteria were agreed in advance: compare against them, not by taste.

A Claude-drafted board paper asks the board to approve a new regional depot. Board members read it the evening before the meeting.

A reviewer finds four faults in the draft.

Which fault most needs fixing before the paper goes out?

A Bullet points use two different styles

B One paragraph repeats a point made earlier

C The appendix pages are not numbered

D The decision the board must make appears only on page nine, after the background

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which fault most needs fixing before the paper goes out?

A Bullet points use two different styles

Cosmetic. Meaning is unaffected.

B One paragraph repeats a point made earlier

Untidy, but the point still lands.

C The appendix pages are not numbered

A minor navigation fault.

D The decision the board must make appears only on page nine, after the background

The main point is buried; readers may miss what they must decide.

THE SIGNAL

A decision paper with the decision buried: lead with what the board must decide.

In five lines

- **Same facts, different reader, different document.** Ask what they need first.
- **Bottom line up front** for busy readers: answer, why, what next, detail.
- **Worst defects change meaning:** contradictions and buried main points.
- **Format by what happens next:** read once, inline; kept or presented, artifact; many records or a system, structured data.
- **Compare drafts against criteria**, not preference.

COMING UP

Domain 2 complete. Next, Domain 3: choosing the right feature.